

Ryterra

Cosmological Foundation

Before Ryterra, twelve divine entities wandered the cosmos, each nurturing their own planets/worlds. Some were immaculately crafted with flora and earth. Others existed with only a barren landscape, and a desolate sort of beauty emerged from within their dark endless planes. Each was an expression of a singular vision. But divinity, for all its power, shares one weakness with mortality: the ache of isolation. The Unitarium emerged from six pairs of diametrically opposed forces, drawn together by this sense of incompleteness. Order sought chaos to define itself; life needed death to give meaning to existence. Light and shadow, creation and destruction, knowledge and mystery, freedom and fate. Each recognized they were halves of larger truths. When the twelve planets compressed, Ryterra was formed.

Timeline

The Trepidation Era (c. 50,000 years)

Early Trepidation (first 40,000 years): No permanent settlements possible. Proto-creatures emerged and went extinct in cycles. The planet's magic was wild and unstructured. Spells didn't exist because reality itself was too unstable to manipulate predictably.

Late Trepidation (last 10,000 years): Patterns began to emerge. Seasons became somewhat predictable. The first truly stable landmasses formed. Humanoid races appeared; either created by lingering divine influence or evolved from earlier life that had survived the chaos. These early peoples were nomadic by necessity, following stable zones and fleeing catastrophes.

The first permanent settlements emerged around natural fonts of stability, places where the divine forces had reached equilibrium. These became sacred sites, many still revered in the Post-Exodus era.

The Age of Cosmos (3,000 years)

First 500 years: The gods descended in waves, each choosing regions or peoples to patron. The first Crownsouls were less champions of the gods and more anchors; mortals who could withstand direct divine contact and channel it to make reality more stable. Magic went from a wild environmental phenomenon to something that could be studied, categorized, and taught.

Next 1,500 years: The Serrian Empire rose to prominence, built on stable magic and divine favor. The schools of magic were formalized. Scientific advances came rapidly because reality was finally consistent. The artifacts from this period seem impossible to modern mages because they were made when the gods walked among mortals.

Last 1,000 years: Tensions emerged. Different Crownsouls interpreted their gods' wills differently. Mortal kingdoms expanded into each other's territories. Philosophical questions about free will versus divine purpose sparked conflicts. The seeds of the Diametric Period were planted here.

The Diametric Period (2,500 years)

First 1,200 years: The War of Crowns. This period saw the rise and fall of dozens of empires, each backed by divine power. The Crownsouls became god-kings and prophet-generals. Battles were fought with magic that modern scholars cannot comprehend.

This is when the fundamental magical laws began to break down again, reality couldn't sustain so much divine power being channeled through it. Regions appeared where magic worked differently or not at all. "Deadlands" emerged where the divine forces had cancelled each other out so completely that even life struggled to exist.

Next 800 years: Eventually open warfare between god-factions broke out, with continents as their battlegrounds. The planet's geography was rewritten. Mountain ranges rose overnight. Seas drained or appeared. Entire civilizations were erased.

The Unitarium itself divided into three major factions:

- Aevros, Pyrrith, Silvareth, Marivex - Gods of preservation, structure, and knowledge; sought to establish divine law

- Nythera, Torvaen, Xythran, Orventhal - Gods of change and freedom; fought for mortal autonomy
- Sorethar, Thalendra, Veridros, Kaltheris - Gods who embodied both creation and destruction; equalibrists; attempted to maintain balance

Last 500 years: The Exodus. Ryterra itself was breaking under the strain of divine power. Equilibrist dieties convinced the other factions that continued presence would destroy the world they had created. The withdrawal was gradual. First pulling back direct intervention, then speaking only through visions and signs, some going completely silent. The last Crownsouls died within a generation of the gods' departure.

Post-Exodus (5,000 years to present)

First 1,500 years: Mortal societies had to relearn how to survive without direct divine intervention. Magic was weaker but more stable. Civilizations reformed around the ruins of Cosmic-era cities. Much knowledge was lost, as previously scholars had relied on divine inspiration or guidance from Crownsoul for insight into the greater planes. The first few centuries saw a dark age as populations recovered and knowledge was painstakingly reconstructed from fragments.

Next 2,000 years: New minor and lesser dieties emerged. New empires rose. The Atrinian Empire and Euvres emerged during this period, building on rediscovered Cosmic-age principles adapted for a world without gods. Trade networks re-established. New schools of magic developed.

Last 1,500 years: War of Towers between the Atrinian Empire and Euvres, about 500 years ago. Modern society has achieved stability but has also grown complacent. The gods are mythology to most people, real history to scholars. Ancient artifacts are sought after. Rumors of the gods' return sometimes surface during times of crisis like plagues, wars, and natural disasters. Some are genuine mystical experiences. Most are wishful thinking. A few might be real.

Unitarium Deities

The Astral Pair

- Soretha: war, the sun, conquest, glory, wrath
- Thalendrus: peace, moons, unity, diplomacy, reconciliation

The Temporal Pair

- Marivex: time, the sea, currents (literal and metaphorical), history
- Orventhal: fate, beasts (as they follow instinct/destiny), stars, prophecy

The Volatile Pair

- Kaltheris: ice, destruction, decay, forgetting
- Pyrrith: fire, craftsmanship, creation, permanence

The Vital Pair

- Aevros: birth, life, order, law, structure
- Nythera: murder, death, chaos, disorder

The Wandering Pair

- Torvaen: storms, travelers, honor, oaths, change
- Veridros: forests, dreams, memories, perception, madness

The Elusive Pair

- Silvareth: health, nature, knowledge, growth, truth
- Xythran: poison, trickery, wealth, secrets, lies

General Time?

A year lasts 360 days, there are 9 months in a year, and each month is 40 days.

The Nine Months: Serra, Dostent, Ifarst, Trofost, Nav, Greera, Prenor, Noxlm, Filexis

Festivals and Holidays

Lundive (celebrating the eclipse of Aurorath and Thalior moons with the sun). An ancient celebration, dating to the Trepidation Era when early peoples tracked celestial events to predict safe periods. The eclipse marks a moment of balance; when even the moons and the sun, (representing different divine aspects) align. Celebrated with prophecy-seeking.

Harvest Close (last day of Ifarst to first of Trofost): A practical agricultural festival that took on religious significance during the Age of Cosmos, when harvest success was attributed to divine favor. Modern celebrations retain the religious trappings but are primarily community gatherings marking seasonal transition.

Naturalia: Originated in the Diametric Period as a midwinter festival asserting life and community in the face of divine warfare. Gift-giving represented the idea that mortals could sustain each other without divine intervention.

Geography, Nations, and Territories



The Atrinian Empire:

A dominant continental power. Structured, traditional, militarily strong. Highly bureaucratic with strong central authority. Values martial prowess and civic duty. Multi-ethnic from historical conquests, now unified under imperial identity. Major cities/landmarks:

- Treveloft (Capital)
- Dothajek
- Grajelhem
- Edin
- Yeltecam
- The Irosted Peaks
- Veth Amaro

Euvres:

Council-based government. Strong maritime tradition. Cultural emphasis on scholarly accomplishment and meritocracy. Major cities/landmarks:

- Dasrinar
- Sartrim
- Galinar
- Thiafar
- The Deltian Coast
- Ichaeron
 - Raven's Nest

Edralis:

Most geographically diverse with floating islands and coastal regions. Loose federation of very different cultures. Possibly the most magically advanced nation, with strong aerial technology.

Major cities/landmarks:

- The States of Aerolight
 - Floating island states, held up by cosmic-age enchantments.
 - Talhati, Kolaku, Rumali
- Os Krev
- Weysevian Coast
- Finardos

The Chatha Dominion

Theocracy. Highly centralized power, smaller population, mostly desert. Major cities/landmarks:

- Crevaskes
- Shirvan
- Brawn

Basao

Merchant republic. Major cities/landmarks:

- Cyn (capital)
- Brasla
- Gallmar
- Slota
- Eurika Springs
 - Raven's Roost

The Isles of Acendar

- Weird cults and whatnot. Jungle climate. Does it even exist? Who knows....